

PROBLEM OF EVIL

FORMS OF EVIL → LOGICAL PROBLEM AND DEFENCE → SOUL-MAKING AND NATURAL ORDER → LEIBNIZ, AUGUSTINE AND PROCESS → EVIDENTIAL EVIL → INDIAN RESPONSE MATRIX

Read the thick cyan rail from Stage 00 to the final core synthesis. Each card uses a concept-appropriate structure; the grey E card is optional enrichment only and never repairs missing core content.

PRIMARY CORE FLOW SUBORDINATE EXTRA APPROVAL / REVIEW

Approval: FALSE • Pending user review • source generation g10 and all prior artifacts unchanged

CORE BEFORE EXTRA • prior artefacts unchanged • exact same master drives poster and tiles

00

STAGE 00FORMS OF EVIL

FORMS OF EVILFREELY CAUSED CRUELTY, OPPRESSION, BETRAYALDISEASE, EARTHQUAKE, CONGENITAL SUFFERINGSUFFERING THAT THREATENS LIFE'S OVERALL MEANINGPAIN PREDATING HUMAN AGENCYPROBLEM TYPES LOGICALGOD AND EVIL ARE STRICTLY INCONSISTENT EVIDENTIALAMOUNT/KINDS OF EVIL MAKE GOD IMPROBABLE EXISTENTIAL

natural: disease, earthquake, congenital suffering

SOURCE / DOCTRINE

- moral: freely caused cruelty, oppression, betrayal
- natural: disease, earthquake, congenital suffering

horrendous: suffering that threatens life's overall meaning

ARGUMENT / MECHANISMD

- horrendous: suffering that threatens life's overall meaning
- animal/evolutionary: pain predating human agency

animal/evolutionary: pain predating human agency

IMPLICATION / VERDICT

- PROBLEM TYPES logical: God and evil are strictly inconsistent evidential: amount/kinds of evil make God improbable existential: suffering
- disrupts trust, worship and meaning

MECHANISM / VERDICT — High-value transition: Animal suffering is a central evidential challenge because predation, disease, parasitism and extinction precede human agency and often seem unrelated to moral growth.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: High-value transition: Animal suffering is a central evidential challenge because predation, disease, parasitism and extinction precede human agency and often seem unrelated to moral growth.

01

STAGE 01LOGICAL PROBLEM AND DEFENCE

LOGICAL PROBLEM AND DEFENCECLAIMED SETOMNIPOTENT GOD + OMNISCIENT GOD + PERFECTLY GOOD GODA GOOD, POWERFUL BEING ELIMINATES EVERY EVIL IT CANPLANTINGA FREE-WILL DEFENCE SIGNIFICANT FREEDOMPossibility of moral wrongGOD CANNOT CAUSE A CREATURE TO CHOOSE FREELY ANDCOMPATIBILITY IS DEFENDED; ACTUAL QUANTITY OF EVIL IS NOT

PLANTINGA FREE-WILL DEFENCE significant freedom → possibility of moral wrong

CLAIMED SET: omnipotent God + omniscient God + perfectly good God + evil exists missing

God cannot cause a creature to choose freely and guarantee only right choices transworld depravity

RESULT: compatibility is defended; actual quantity of evil is not thereby explained.

SOURCE / DOCTRINE

- CLAIMED SET: omnipotent God + omniscient God + perfectly good God + evil exists missing premise: a good, powerful being eliminates every evil it can
- PLANTINGA FREE-WILL DEFENCE significant freedom → possibility of moral wrong

ARGUMENT / MECHANISMD

- God cannot cause a creature to choose freely and guarantee only right choices transworld depravity shows logical possibility of unavoidable misuse
- RESULT: compatibility is defended; actual quantity of evil is not thereby explained.

IMPLICATION / VERDICT

- CLAIMED SET: omnipotent God + omniscient God + perfectly good God + evil exists missing premise: a good, powerful being eliminates every evil it can
- PLANTINGA FREE-WILL DEFENCE significant freedom → possibility of moral wrong

MECHANISM / VERDICT — RESULT: compatibility is defended; actual quantity of evil is not thereby explained.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: compatibility is defended; actual quantity of evil is not thereby explained.

02

STAGE 02SOUL-MAKING AND NATURAL ORDER

SOUL-MAKING AND NATURAL ORDERJOHN HICK EPISTEMIC DISTANCE + STABLE NATURAL LAWS +GENUINE AGENCY STRUGGLECOURAGE, COMPASSION, RESPONSIBILITYPERSON-MAKING STRENGTHADDRESSES WHY A READY-MADE PARADISE MAY DEFEAT MATURE FREEDOMVICTIMS USED AS MEANS; SUFFERING IS EXCESSIVE AND UNEVENINFANTS, ANIMALS AND HORRORS DO NOT RELIABLY IMPROVE SUFFERERS

suffering is excessive and uneven

IRENÆUS / JOHN HICK epistemic distance + stable natural laws + risk → genuine agency

infants, animals and horrors do not reliably improve sufferers reply requires afterlife fulfillment/universal restoration, which

SOURCE / DOCTRINE

- IRENÆUS / JOHN HICK epistemic distance + stable natural laws + risk → genuine agency struggle → courage,
- suffering is excessive and uneven

ARGUMENT / MECHANISMD

- infants, animals and horrors do not reliably improve sufferers reply requires afterlife fulfillment/universal restoration, which adds further commitments.
- IRENÆUS / JOHN HICK epistemic distance + stable natural laws + risk → genuine agency struggle → courage,

IMPLICATION / VERDICT

- suffering is excessive and uneven
- infants, animals and horrors do not reliably improve sufferers reply requires afterlife fulfillment/universal restoration, which adds further commitments.

MECHANISM / VERDICT — IRENÆUS / JOHN HICK epistemic distance + stable natural laws + risk → genuine agency struggle → courage, compassion, responsibility → person-making strength; addresses why a ready-made paradise may defeat mature freedom objections: victims used as means; suffering is excessive and uneven;

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: High-value transition: The moral danger is instrumentalization: 'treating victims' suffering as a means to another person's virtue, historical progress or cosmic beauty.

03

STAGE 03LEIBNIZ, AUGUSTINE AND PROCESS REVISIONS

LEIBNIZ, AUGUSTINE AND PROCESS REVISIONSEVIL IS PRIVATIO BONI, NOT A CREATED SUBSTANCE, MISUSEBEST POSSIBLE WORLD BALANCES LAWS, FREEDOM AND TOTAL COMPOSSIBILITYGOD MAY PERMIT EVIL FOR A GREATER GOOD, NEVERPROCESS THEISMGOD PERSUADES BUT CANNOT UNILATERALLY PREVENT EVERY EVENTPRIVATION DOES NOT LESSEN FELT HORROR; "BEST" CAN SEEMGREATER-GOOD REASONING RISKS INSTRUMENTALISING VICTIMS; PROCESS VIEW REVISES OMNIPOTENCE.

SYSTEM / DOCTRINE	DECISIVE DISTINCTION	EVALUATION / TRAP
AUGUSTINE: evil is privatio boni, not a created substance; misuse of freedom disorders good	AQUINAS: God may permit evil for a greater good, never will evil as evil	COSTS: privation does not lessen felt horror; "best" can seem complacent
LEIBNIZ: best possible world balances laws, freedom and total compossibility	PROCESS THEISM: God persuades but cannot unilaterally prevent every event	greater-good reasoning risks instrumentalising victims; process view revises omnipotence.

SOURCE / DOCTRINE

- AUGUSTINE: evil is privatio boni, not a created substance; misuse of freedom disorders good
- LEIBNIZ: best possible world balances laws, freedom and total compossibility

DECISIVE DISTINCTION

- AQUINAS: God may permit evil for a greater good, never will evil as evil
- PROCESS THEISM: God persuades but cannot unilaterally prevent every event

EVALUATION / TRAP

- COSTS: privation does not lessen felt horror; "best" can seem complacent
- greater-good reasoning risks instrumentalising victims; process view revises omnipotence.

MECHANISM / VERDICT — Recommended opening definition: Augustine treats evil as a privation of good arising through created freedom, not as a positive substance created by God.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Recommended opening definition: Augustine treats evil as a privation of good arising through created freedom, not as a positive substance created by God.

04

STAGE 04EVIDENTIAL EVIL

EVIDENTIAL EVILAPPARENTLY POINTLESS SUFFERING EXISTS; AN OMNIPOTENT GOOD GOD WOULD THEREFORE GOD'S EXISTENCE IS IMPROBABLE HIDDEN FAWN CASE TESTSKEPTICAL THEISMLIMITED HUMAN COGNITION CANNOT INFER "NO REASON" FROM "NO ABSENCE OF EVIDENCE IS EVIDENCE ONLY WHERE DETECTION SHOULD"TOO MUCH SCEPTICISM ALSO WEAKENS PROVIDENTIAL AND MORAL REASONING

SOURCE / DOCTRINE

- ROWE: apparently pointless suffering exists; an omnipotent good God would prevent it
- therefore God's existence is improbable hidden fawn case tests gratuitous natural suffering without human freedom

ARGUMENT / MECHANISMD

- SKEPTICAL THEISM: limited human cognition cannot infer "no reason" from "no reason seen"
- CORNEA: absence of evidence is evidence only where detection should be expected objection: too much scepticism also weakens

IMPLICATION / VERDICT

- providential and moral reasoning verdict must weigh epistemic humility against the specificity of apparently gratuitous evil.
- ROWE: apparently pointless suffering exists; an omnipotent good God would prevent it

MECHANISM / VERDICT — CORNEA: absence of evidence is evidence only where detection should be expected objection: too much scepticism also weakens providential and moral reasoning verdict must weigh epistemic humility against the specificity of apparently gratuitous evil.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: absence of evidence is evidence only where detection should be expected objection: too much scepticism also weakens providential and moral reasoning verdict must weigh epistemic humility against the specificity of apparently gratuitous evil.

05

STAGE 05INDIAN RESPONSE MATRIX

INDIAN RESPONSE MATRIXSUFFERING BELONGS TO VYĀVAHĀRIKA AVIDYĀ; ULTIMATE BRAHMAN IS NON-DUALREAL SOULS/WORLD, KARMA, GRACE AND PURPOSEFUL DIVINE ORDERBEGINNINGLESS KARMA ALLOCATED BY ĪŚVARA; GOD IS NOT ARBITRARYKARMIC MATTER BINDS JĪVA; NO CREATOR BEARS RESPONSIBILITYDUḤKHA FROM DEPENDENT ORIGINATION, CRAVING AND IGNORANCE; NO CREATORKARMA EXPLAINS MORAL CONTINUITY BUT FACES FIRST-ORIGIN, VICTIM-BLAMING ANDLIBERATION ROUTES ANSWER SUFFERING THERAPEUTICALLY, NOT ALWAYS AS A

SYSTEM / DOCTRINE	DECISIVE DISTINCTION	EVALUATION / TRAP
ADVĀITA: suffering belongs to vyāvahārika avidyā; ultimate Brahman is non-dual	JAINA: karmic matter binds jīva; no creator bears responsibility	liberation routes answer suffering therapeutically, not always as a theodicy.
VIŚIṢṬĀDVĀITA: real souls/world, karma, grace and purposeful divine order	BUDDHISM: duḥkha from dependent origination, craving and ignorance; no creator problem	
NYĀYA: beginningless karma allocated by īśvara; God is not arbitrary author of deserts	KARMA explains moral continuity but faces first-origin, victim-blaming and natural-evil pressures	

SOURCE / DOCTRINE

- ADVĀITA: suffering belongs to vyāvahārika avidyā; ultimate Brahman is non-dual
- VIŚIṢṬĀDVĀITA: real souls/world, karma, grace and purposeful divine order
- NYĀYA: beginningless karma allocated by īśvara; God is not arbitrary author of deserts

DECISIVE DISTINCTION

- JAINA: karmic matter binds jīva; no creator bears responsibility
- BUDDHISM: duḥkha from dependent origination, craving and ignorance; no creator problem
- KARMA explains moral continuity but faces first-origin, victim-blaming and natural-evil pressures

EVALUATION / TRAP

- liberation routes answer suffering therapeutically, not always as a theodicy.

MECHANISM / VERDICT — Recommended opening definition: Indian traditions do not share one answer because they disagree about creator, self, world, karma (morally consequential action) and liberation.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Recommended opening definition: Indian traditions do not share one answer because they disagree about creator, self, world, karma (morally consequential action) and liberation.

06

STAGE 06HARD CASES AND ETHICAL LIMITS

HARD CASES AND ETHICAL LIMITSTEST ANY THEODICY AGAINST CHILD SUFFERINGANIMAL PAINUNEQUAL OPPORTUNITYDOES RESPONSE EXPLAIN, MERELY DEFEND LOGICAL POSSIBILITY, OR OFFERDOES IT PRESERVE VICTIM DIGNITY? DOES IT MAKE PREVENTABLEANTI-THEODICY WARNINGNEAT JUSTIFICATION CAN REPEAT HARM REPLY

SYSTEM / DOCTRINE	DECISIVE DISTINCTION	EVALUATION / TRAP
TEST ANY THEODICY AGAINST child suffering	ASK: does response explain, merely defend logical possibility, or offer pastoral meaning?	moral protest may itself express commitment to goodness.
animal pain	does it preserve victim dignity? does it make preventable evil morally acceptable?	
unequal opportunity	anti-theodicy warning: neat justification can repeat harm reply: philosophical explanation need not command passive acceptance	

SOURCE / DOCTRINE

- TEST ANY THEODICY AGAINST child suffering
- animal pain
- unequal opportunity

DECISIVE DISTINCTION

- ASK: does response explain, merely defend logical possibility, or offer pastoral meaning?
- does it preserve victim dignity? does it make preventable evil morally acceptable?
- anti-theodicy warning: neat justification can repeat harm reply: philosophical explanation need not command passive acceptance

EVALUATION / TRAP

- moral protest may itself express commitment to goodness.

MECHANISM / VERDICT — High-value transition: Separate logical from evidential evil, defence from theodicy, explanation from justification and causal responsibility from moral permission.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: High-value transition: Separate logical from evidential evil, defence from theodicy, explanation from justification and causal responsibility from moral permission.

07

STAGE 07PYQ AND ANSWER SYNTHESIS

PYQ AND ANSWER SYNTHESISDEFINE GOD-CONCEPT + EVIL TYPESEPARATE LOGICAL/EVIDENTIAL/EXISTENTIAL DEMANDFORMAL ARGUMENTSTRONGEST DEFENCE/THEODICYHARD-CASE OBJECTIONINDIAN COMPARISON ON KARMA/DUḤKHA10 MARKS

DEFINE God-concept + evil type → separate logical/evidential/existential demand

formal argument → strongest defence/theodicy → hard-case objection

Indian comparison on karma/duḥkha → qualified verdict

10 marks: one problem + one response + evaluation

15 marks: logical/evidential distinction + two responses

SOURCE / DOCTRINE

- DEFINE God-concept + evil type → separate logical/evidential/existential demand
- formal argument → strongest defence/theodicy → hard-case objection
- Indian comparison on karma/duḥkha → qualified verdict

ARGUMENT / MECHANISMD

- 10 marks: one problem + one response + evaluation
- 15 marks: logical/evidential distinction + two responses
- 20 marks: Western and Indian matrix + hard cases + concept revision

IMPLICATION / VERDICT

- CLOSE: evil may not disprove every God-concept, but it severely tests classical omni-God belief and forces costs in
- freedom, providence, power, afterlife or human understanding.

MECHANISM / VERDICT — Indian comparison on karma/duḥkha → qualified verdict

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Core argument: Logical: omni-power + perfect goodness + evil + unrestricted bridge premises - inconsistency.

E

EXTRASUBORDINATE ENRICHMENT — ONLY AFTER THE COMPLETE CORE

OPTIONAL ADVANCED ENRICHMENTADVANCED-DOSSIER RECONCILIATION — [OPTIONAL ADVANCED]ADVANCED SEMINAR MODULES - FROM COMPETENT TO EXAMINER-GRADETHE SECTION DOSSIER MARKS SKEPTICAL THEISM AND HORRENDOUS EVILSTEACHES CORNEA, REPRESENTATIVENESS, BALANCING-OFF VERSUS DEFEAT, AND GOODNESS-TO-PERSONS.THEIR OPTIONAL RESIDUE IS SECOND-ORDERWHETHER A POSITIVE THEODICY CAN BE COMBINED CONSISTENTLY WITHDEFEAT WITHIN A SUFFERER'S LIFE IS STILL A GENERAL

OPTIONAL SOURCE WITNESS

- Advanced-dossier reconciliation — [OPTIONAL ADVANCED]
- Advanced Seminar Modules - From Competent to Examiner-Grade
- The section dossier marks skeptical theism and horrendous evils as promoted to core because the owner source now
- teaches CORNEA, representativeness, balancing-off versus defeat, and goodness-to-persons.

ADVANCED OBJECTION

- Their optional residue is second-order: whether a positive theodicy can be combined consistently with global skepticism, and whether
- defeat within a sufferer's life is still a general theodicy.
- Free-will treatment of natural evil and victim-blaming critiques of karma remain high-value comparative refinements, not stand-alone catalogues.
- Modal logic without notation overload ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM High-value transition: The logical problem is

COMPARATIVE NUANCE

- a question about whether the relevant propositions can be true.
- [THESIS] The logical problem is a question about whether the relevant propositions can be true together in at least one possible world.
- [ARGUMENT] Three modal ideas must be kept separate.
- First, logical possibility means that a description contains no contradiction.

OPTIONAL STATUS — This optional depth is unnecessary for a competent core answer; use it only for added nuance after the complete core has been written.

END OF MASTER CANVAS • poster embeds this exact master • tiled pages are overlapping crops of the same pixels